

No. 741, July 2011

Vertigo

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club
Wellington Section

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

The Odyssey Wall, Kawakawa Bay
Image courtesy of Rob Addis

Next section night: 4 July, 2011

First Ascent SW Face of Ombigaichang Nepal and The Dolomites, by Rob Addis

Rob will be giving us a variety show tonight:

- Mighty Dolomiti: two weeks and 84 pitches of rock in the Dolomites.
- Ombigaichang: a 20 minute movie of their first ascent of the SW Face.
- Groundups trailer: a short movie of new routes on the Odyssey Wall at Kawakawa Bay.



Ombigaichang in Nepal



Climbing
the Comici
Route on
Cima
Grande

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.

The Wellington Section Photo Competition results

Last year's competition proved very strong with the Wellington Section going on to win the Egmont-Tasman trophy in the inter-section category of the NZAC national photographic competition.

This year's photo competition was down slightly from last year on entries with 95 images entered, but the quality was as impressive as before. It is hoped that our local competition will once again serve as a stern proving ground for our photographers in the national competition.

Champion Rock Climbing and Overall Champion

Flock Air by John Palmer

As Overall Champion John was awarded a season pass to Mt Ruapehu, and as Rock Climbing Champion he was awarded a 10 pass to Ferg's.



Top Judges' Pick

Horizontal Jamming Hell by John Palmer
Awarded a daypack from Macpac.



Champion Alpine Activity

Into the White by Stefanie Pontasch
Awarded a gift voucher from Bivouac Outdoor.



Champion Alpine General

Sawcut Gorge, Seaward Kaikouras by Andy Maloney
Awarded a gift voucher from Bivouac Outdoor.



Champion Humour

Ropework by Clare Thomson
Awarded a gift voucher from Bivouac Outdoor



Champion Alpine Nature

Launch by Peter Laurensen
Awarded a gift voucher from Bivouac Outdoor.



Champion Photojournalism

Pondering by Peter Laurenson

Awarded a gift voucher from Bivouac Outdoor.



Thanks and appreciations

Our congratulations is extended to all the winners and achievers.

Also our thanks is extended to our panel of judges Andy Reisinger, John Rhodes, Shaun Barnett and Matt Evans.

And finally our thanks to the sponsors for again supporting the event with some marvelous prizes.

This year's photo competition sponsored by:



Five Kiwis tackle the Haute Route, 2011

Blair Leslie

This trip was covered in the previous issue of Vertigo, but no photos were able to be included. The following images show what Blair and his crew got up to.





Ski Mountaineering Crumbs

John Nankervis

An organic group of mature Welly, Otago and North Otago Sectioneers have combined on many occasions over recent years for ski mountaineering excursions in NZ and beyond . Highlights in the last year have been journeys to Kashmir (India) and the Selkirks (Canada).

Curry Powder: Last year John Wild, Dave Bamford, Ket Bradshaw, Nick and Dara Shearer and John Nankervis went to Gulmarg, near Srinigar and the Line of Control. There is a ski hill there but the nature of it is that much of the action involves skinning up the ridge of Apharwat Mountain (above 4,000 metres) and skiing lines in the huge basins emanating from the

ridge. On fine days great views of the Western Himalaya including Nanga Parbat (8,000m) its massive cornerpost in nearby Pakistan, and the excitement of skiing accidentally down into (and being escorted out of) the Indian army camp. The snow pack at Gulmarg is always challenging but in that season it was especially sensitive. We honed our avalanche skills ! Sadly, just after we left, a huge avalanche swept down from one of the basins into the forest burying many soldiers. At least 16 were killed. Gulmarg is fast becoming a hideaway for adventurous kiwi skiers with a taste for Indian cuisine and the unpredictable.



Former NZAC President, Dave Bamford, tries to placate the Indian Army – Gulmarg.

Selkirk Passes: Earlier this year the two Johns, Nick and Dara were joined by Paul Maxim and Trudy and Jeremy Shearer on a mixed down hilling and ski touring excursion to Southern BC, based at Rossland and Revelstoke. Memorable were runs off Lightening Strike above Kootenay Pass, touring from Strawberry Pass and two wonderful trips out of that road-accessed

touring mecca , Rogers Pass - a long run on a bluebird day from above Balu Pass in the Connaught Valley and, with former Welly Section-eers, Clive and Wilma Rubens, a less bluebird crossing of Lookout Col from the Illecillewaet to the Asulkan valleys. The snow pack was invariably deep and meaningful and unlike Kashmir, stability was mainly good.



Jeremy Shearer above Balu Pass.



Unidentifiable North Otago Section member executes perfect turn below Lookout Col , Illecillewaet Valley , Glacier National Park

Mont Salève: Geneva April 2011

Nina Sawicki

By some fate (or unconscious masochism) our family took off on a long-haul flight to Europe some 72 hours after I completed the OXFAM 100 km trail-walker on Saturday (09/04/2011).

I hobbled to work on the Monday and attempted to see a few patients. Kind nurses applied fixo-mil to extensive juicy blisters. We flew on Wednesday and I wore compression stockings followed by tramping boots on top. During the flight I felt that familiar throb of wounded bruised tissues. A liberal dose of alcohol dulled the pain and prayed I would be able climb when I got off the plane and not end up in hospital with a DVT (very embarrassing). So, we arrived jet lagged after 24 hours of flying many movies and little sleep, but it was a fresh sunny spring in the Swiss Alps and so we made our way to Mont Salève!

Geneva's closest mountain, Le Salève has a lot to offer. It is 600m to 1200m to the top and is "Calcaire rock" (limestone) with wonderful hand-holds and good friction for smearing. It has bouldering at the bottom, a long route on the west face and several huge overhanging, cracks with more than 450 routes of different grades.

It is the path of the mountain's face which is, along with the Sentier d'Orjobet, the most travelled. Without being really difficult, Grande Gorge Intérieure has some tricky passages which can deter those not accustomed to the rock faces. This path was created back in 1854. The decision to arrange this way followed upon a number of accidents which had occurred in this zone (one can suppose that the original path followed more or less the route of Grande



Gorge Intérieure). In fact an accident happened here within the last year. While the climbing is not difficult it is very exposed, and some steel chains were added here following the recent accident.

The track leaves Sentier de la Grande Gorge at Reposoir and crosses the ravine resulting from the bottom of Grande Gorge. It is worth, to make a small excursion here, to have a look at Grotte Juillard. The path reaches a flat ledge being located behind Rocher de la Poupée, to later climb, on the opposite side to the spire, through ledges and rocks. It continues then, with some laces, to reach the foot of Tour du Sarrot. There, it takes to the left to join a rock gully, where the use of hands is necessary. It then reaches the bottom of Grande Gorge itself after having crossed Trou du Chat. Not far from there is the junction towards Rochers de Onze Heures and Vires du Sarrot Saut-Gonet

We took a route of seven pitches alternating with rock scrambling and a bit of abseiling. We finished up in a huge overhanging cavern and

simply could not see a way out. However, just below one's foot placement was a wee hole though which you squeezed your way through to into a cave (complete with fire-place). I imagine many fine nights were spent here by our cave-dwelling ancestors. We started off with tramping boots then switched to rock-shoes.

From here we made careful steep descent down the back face of the mountain.

We felt quite pleased with our effort but were put in our place by a party of two who were roped up together: a man of 75 leading woman in her 60s. We had just recovered from this when we met a second man of 70 who soloed the whole route "une bonne excursion pout l'appetit avant le diner!".

Well, when we exited the cave and were carefully making our way down the steep slabs from the summit of the mountain two joggers passed us: running the whole route! However, they were mountain guides training for the season ahead!



Kahurangi National Park / Mount Owen

Jane Hall

Trip Participants: Hinrich Schafer, Mark Burns, Julie Deslippe, Wiebke Heise, Mike Hall, Jane Hall.

"I've made inquiries with the NZ Alpine Club about a trip over Queen's Birthday Weekend", announced Mike over breakfast one morning recently. I had envisaged a weekend catching up with family and friends with a day walk or two, but jumped at the chance to go when I heard it was more a tramp than a climbing trip.

After a couple of succinct emails from Hinrich Schafer, the trip coordinator, we gathered our gear together and met Julie, Mark and Wiebke at the Interislander Terminal on Friday afternoon and enjoyed a smooth sailing to Picton. Before long we were loaded into a hired van and were on our way to Blenheim for an emergency stop at the Warehouse for a waterproof jacket for one of our team, followed by an Italian meal. Courtesy of some good driving by Hinrich and navigating by Mark, we arrived at Courthouse Flat three hours later. Tents went up efficiently in the dark and we all dived into our sleeping bags.

There was some rain during the night, but only light drizzle as we breakfasted and got packed up ready to leave Courthouse Flat – a very pretty camping spot in the light of day. We had a choice of two routes for the first few kilometres of our tramp and chose the "more gradual ridge walk" rather than the Valley walk followed by a steep climb at the end. The ridge walk, between Blue and Granity Creeks was pretty steep and with no chance to warm up on gentle ground it was rather a strenuous exercise! Conditions were damp and clouds covered up any views. We discovered fungi of all shapes and sizes in amongst the leaf mould and even Julie the botanist amongst us was impressed by the bright blue, purple and tiny red mushrooms.

We headed down through Beech forest to a saddle and then descended steeply via The Staircase to where the track sidles around marble bluffs and down into Blue Creek. We boulder hopped up the dry creek bed, tramped through some sub-alpine vegetation and suddenly there was the hut, on view sooner than we'd dared hope. Our trip had taken five hours, including a lunch stop and several drink breaks, as it was thirsty work.

Granity Pass Hut (1220m) has 12 bunks and is situated on a moraine with very pretty views to dark limestone massifs on both sides and creek valleys. After we had imbibed tea and soup a group of four young Cantabrian men joined us in the hut and amused us with their cooking antics.it seems one of them thought bringing breakfast lunch and dinner meant many cans of baked beans. As the

light dimmed we cooked our evening meals. Mark cooked for himself and Wiebke, but is used to cooking for his family of five, so had more than enough curry. Some of our party were in bed by 6.30pm and the hut was quiet not too long after that.

The next morning dawned cloudy and wet again and we took our time over breakfast while we waited for the weather to make up it's mind. Mike earned Brownie points by making freshly brewed coffee, then we donned wet weather gear and set off for Mount Owen about 10.30am. We followed a well defined path through tussock grassland to Sentinel Ridge. At this point Jane and Mike decided to return to the hut and enjoyed some sunny breaks as the surrounding massifs revealed themselves. The others went on to the east of Sentinel Hill, walked through a saddle past several small tarns, then followed rock cairns up hill through glaciated marble and alpine herb fields to the summit. It was cold and wet on the top (1875m) and despite spending some time there, the clouds did not depart and the breath taking views sadly did not emerge. This group of four sauntered back down to the hut enjoying the scenery and stopping to take lots of photos.

A lone trumper, S, joined us in the hut around 5.30pm and didn't need much encouragement to help Mark and Wiebke eat the rest of their curry and rice. We had a "late night" (8.30ish!) chatting, reading, playing cards and Scrabble. S was up early Monday morning to walk to Sentinel Ridge and we were ready to leave the hut before 9am, leaving the "Boys" to finish tidying the hut. We retraced our footprints down hill in light drizzle again and after slipping and sliding a bit on wet tree roots found ourselves back at Courthouse Creek after 3 ½ hours. The sun was shining and some of us had a dip in Granity Creek to freshen up a bit. We had lunch at the picnic table washed down with more of Mike's coffee, packed up the van and headed off down the gravel road.

The trip back to Picton was not without incident. Heavy rain on Sunday had meant that the largest ford was too deep for cars to cross on Sunday afternoon and S's driver was not too keen to drive back in and pick her up, leaving a note to ask her to walk out past that ford. There was no sign of her driver so we gave S a lift to the main road where after an anxious phone call or two we spotted the car and Sandra tumbled gratefully out of our van and into her car.

The drive to Picton was beautiful and we had another smooth sailing back to Wellington, completing a great weekend. Thanks go to Hinrich for his leadership and organisation and to the others for their camaraderie.

Summer Rock 2011

Alice Doughty

Silent feet, glue hands, quickdraws' in place, three deep breaths and let go, trust your equipment, trust your partner, trust your fingers and you can go amazing places! This year's Summer Rock course offered outdoor solid rock experiences for participants who wanted to improve their climbing, abseiling, and leading skills. I was lucky enough to be one of the participants! After climbing casually at Ferg's for over a year, my climbing partner, Lauren, who took the course last summer, encouraged my interest in the course to improve my technique. I was hungry for knowledge and for the feel of pocketed ignimbrite.

After a few practice evenings at Ferg's and some bouldering out at Baring Head, we ventured to Kinloch for a beautiful weekend of climbing, morning yoga, quince-stacking, and swimming. For many people, this was their first outdoor lead climb, and even a 15 can make me a bit nervous on lead, I'll admit. Our next outing took us to Wharepapa South, long drive, but totally worth it! Great weather, great climbs and enthusiastic instructors made for an exhausting weekend. Several of the instructors were eager to climb at the end of the day, so the students had a chance to relax and watch how graceful and precise a good climber can be.

Thanks to Blair and the team for a wonderful course!



Images courtesy of Vincent Zintzen.



Upcoming Club Trips

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

And remember we love to hear about your trips – send stories to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

July 23–24: Ruapehu South

Trip organiser: TBA

Time to head to “our” mountain and start the winter season. From base camp (Ohakune) negotiate treacherous terrain (Turoa ski field) to access the high slopes and cliffs. Exact routes are subject to current conditions, but the potential is vast: amble up Tahurangi peak, explore the valleys around the crater lake or take on hard mixed terrain on Girdlestone Peak.

July 30–31: North Island ice climbing meet

As advertised – contact for the Wellington Section: Hinrich Schaefer.

August: Ice climbing / mountaineering Ruapehu North

Trip organiser: Rob Haws, as previously advertised.

August 19–21: Backcountry ski trip Robert’s Ridge (Nelson Lakes)

Trip organiser: Hinrich Schaefer

One of the most accessible ski trips into true alpine scenery. Bring your backcountry/ski mountaineering gear. No summit for those who make their way to Angelus Hut and beyond, but any number of slopes and bowls for snow, turns, snow, turns, more snow and more turns.

September 10–11: Mt Taranaki

Trip organiser: TBA

Based in Tahurangi Lodge on the East side of the mountain; one day will see us heading to the summit by any of a choice of more or less technical routes. On the second day there is the option to up the ante or explore some of the cliffs that offer great rock climbing.

September 24–25: North Island backcountry ski touring meet

WS contact: Hinrich

Backcountry ski enthusiasts from all North Island NZAC sections gather at Tukino Hut on the East side of Mt. Ruapehu for this meet. Through the ski field there is great access to the terrain up high.

November 18–20: Castle Hill

Trip organiser: TBA

Nobody who is serious about rock needs an intro to bouldering and climbing at Castle Hill. We’ll head over to the South Island and and pull, crimp, balance, dyno, smear and hook as long and as hard as you want.

Wellington Section library – missing books and DVDs

The Wellington Section library has a growing problem of books and DVDs either being removed without being registered first or being borrowed but not being returned within a reasonable period. In the worst cases some books have been removed (or borrowed) for a number of years. There are no hard and fast rules on how long the item may be borrowed but, if members are struggling to read it within a month or two, the librarian suggests that you email him to confirm that you need it for longer or just return it until you have time to read it later.

In the meantime we now URGENTLY need to recall outstanding items. To save the librarian endless phone calls/emails /detective work, please scan the lists below and see if the item isn't residing forgotten on your shelves.

Overdue

508	The Rock Warriors's Way	Ilgner, Arno	Book
504	Training For Climbing	Horst, Eric J	Book
502	Cliffhanger		DVD
500	Traditional Lead Climbing	Pesterfield, Heidi	Book
498	This Game of Ghosts	Joe Simpson	Book
494	Revelations	Jerry Moffat	Book
493	Between a Rock and a Hard Place	Aron Ralston	Book
491	High Misadventure	Paul Hersey	Book
486	Masters of Stone VI	Eric Perlman	DVD
479	Into Thin Air		DVD
475	Rock Climbing Anchors: A Comprehensive Guide	Craig Luebben	Book
466	Arapiles, Selected Climbs	Simon Mentz	Book
460	Rock Climbing - Getting Started	Glenn Tempest	Book
458	Kiss or Kill	Mark Twight	Book
442	K2 - A Challenge to the Sky	Roberto Mantonvani	Book
440	First Ascent	Peter Mortimer	DVD
426	Wellington Rock	Kristen Foley	Guide
387	Southern Faces		DVD
388	New Zealand Backcountry Skiing	James Broadbent	Guide
377	Barron Saddle - Mount Brewster	Ross Cullen	Guide

Missing in Action

481	The Illustrated Guide to Glacier Travel Rescue	Andy Tyson / Mike Clelland	Book
463	Dingle - Discovering the sense of adventure	Graeme Dingle	Book
443	The Boys of Everest	Clint Willis	Book
433	The Darran Mountains	Craig Jeffries	Guide
424	Alpine Skills 34 - Mountain Safety Council	Cathye Haddocjk	Instructional
384	Arthur's Pass - A Guide to Mountaineers	Graeme Kates	Guide
371	High Adventure	Edmund Hillary	Book
370	Avalanche Accidents in Aotearoa	Dave Irwin/Will Macqueen	Book
366	Above the Clouds	Anatoli Boukreev	Book
300	Aoraki Mount Cook, A Guide to Mountaineers	Alex Palman	Guide
299	The Mount Aspiring Region - A Guide for Mountaineers	Allen Uren / Mark Watson	Guide

Notices

Six month membership extension

The winner of NZAC's six month membership extension for July is Vincent Zintzen – a member of

the Wellington Section! Renew your membership when it is due to be in with a chance to win.

Baring Head – Regional Council calling for submissions

I draw your attention to a request from Greater Wellington Regional Council (GWRC) for community consultation on how Baring Head should be managed in the future <http://www.gw.govt.nz/baring-head/>

I suggest that if you have any personal views on how the regional park at Baring Head should be developed then please put in a submission. Submissions close on 31st July 2011.

GWRC has already completed some research into how Baring Head could be developed <http://haveyoursay.gw.govt.nz/baringhead>. The Recreation and Tourism Report of March 2011 in particular thor-

oughly covers the current thinking; lighthouse tourism, historic buildings, development of walking and biking trails, accommodation, river fishing and canoeing, swimming, picnicking.

Also I am preparing a submission on behalf of the Wellington Section of the NZAC and would like you as members and climbers to provide input into this. If you have any thoughts that you would like me to represent in the NZAC submission then please email them to me at jw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

James Wright
Chairperson
Wellington Section, NZAC

Julien Funrock back in New Zealand...

Hello,

I'm Julien. I'm french and I spent 6 months in NZ on 2003. I was on a "the" trip to the Wilkin Valley on April 2003 with Jenny Henshaw, Don French, Kevin Patterson, Garth and some other guys that I can not remember their name (sorry about that !).

To remember: <http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/mainpages/carotrip11.htm>

From the 24th of October to the 25 of November, I'm going to be back to NZ with my wife to show her the country. We have not planned what we are going to do during this month but we want to spend 4 to 5 days in Wellington (as this is the

place where I stay on 2003) at some stage. We would be happy to have a trip tramping as I did with all those folks in the Wilkin valley on 2003. So I'm wondering if something is already plan or if something could be plan...of course if Kiwi accept to welcome two frenchies!

I'm sorry for my English witch is not good as it was a couple of years ago, but I don't have a lot of opportunities to practice...

Thank you advance for your answer.

Best regards,

Céline & Julien (jfunrock@mageos.com)

Palmerston North accomodation and climbing buddies

I'm a student climber from U.S.A and I'll be studying at Massey University from July 13, 2011 through July 2012. I'm looking for a place

to stay in Palmerston North preferably with other students but primarily with other climbers. Email me at Rkutchin@gmail.com

Scarpa touring boots

Scarpa Spirit 4 Touring Boots, size 30 mondo, 2009 model, Very good condition with spares

and manuals. \$350 ono. 0212061640, 03 4174675, or schills79@hotmail.com

Past issues of The Climber

With the recent visit of Tamotsu Nakamura, we have had a request to help complete the Japanese Alpine Club's set of Climber magazines.

We are short a few copies and this is a request to see if any members have the following issues

that we could send on to the JAC Library.

Issues: 2; 9; 13; 14 and 16 . If you can assist please send to Margaret at the NZAC, PO Box 786, Christchurch 8140.

Research Request for 200m Rope

I am a MFA candidate at Elam School of Fine Art at the University of Auckland and my current research is on the retreat of the Tasman Glacier. One of the proposals I am working on involves using a rope with markers attached as measure of the down wastage of the Glacier somewhere near Ball Hut. My collaborators inform me the drop is some 200 metres. My work comes from a position of concern about the degradation of the environment, and as such I am trying to use

repurposed materials as much as possible. I am also interested in the significance of materials and their prior use. I was hoping that someone in the club might have a 200m length of rope which I could borrow/purchase. It doesn't matter if it is no longer safe for climbing; ideally it would have been used in an alpine environment but have reached the end of its use in this capacity. Amelia Hitchcock ahitchcock@gmail.com

Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	James Wright	chairperson	027 472 5561
Vice Chair	Scott Taylor	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Matt Knarston	MK	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
	Hinrich Schaefer	HS	
	Rebecca Thomson	RT	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	Vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
Instruction - AIC	Vacant		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz



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